

So, bitter

i puked your softness, it burned
my mouth,
the aftertaste bloomed like fungus,
metallic veins under my tongue.
i spat it sideways, it hissed.
velvet melting into rot

it rinses. it laughs.
it tastes of rust, and winter leaves,
i cant scrape it off.
no, not with teeth. not with tongue.

i cannot purge. i cannot rinse. i cannot escape

the shadow of you sits,
curling and teasing over my tonsils,
i dont touch water,
it gags me too.

it licks me back.
obscene mimicry of care.
and i gag.
again and again.